

3.3.5 Criticisms of families

Content	Additional information
• Different criticisms of families (isolation and unrealistic idealisation, loss of traditional functions, lack of contact with wider kinship networks, the status and role of women within families, marital breakdown, dysfunctional families). • The work of Zaretsky on developments in families from a Marxist perspective and Delphy and Leonard's feminist critique of families.	Students should be able to: • identify, describe and explain different criticisms of families • describe, compare and contrast a variety of sociological perspectives on these issues (functionalist, feminist and Marxist) • describe the key ideas of Zaretsky (page 46) on families • describe the key ideas of Delphy and Leonard (page 45) on families.